

EXAMEN DU BACCALAURÉAT — SESSION PRINCIPALE 2025

Épreuve : Anglais | Sections : Économie et gestion, Mathématiques, Sciences expérimentales et
Sciences de l'informatique

Durée : 2h | Coefficient : 1 | République tunisienne — Ministère de l'Éducation

 **Correction proposée — bachymed**

 **Important :** This document is a **proposed correction** — non-official. It presents the **methodology, the plan, the required ideas and arguments, as well as vocabulary**. The final writing remains your responsibility: that is precisely what the examiner corrects.

PRELIMINARY TEXT ANALYSIS

Source: The Guardian (Adapted), 13 January 2024.

Topic: The Chiara Ferragni "Pandoro-gate" scandal — influencer marketing, consumer fraud, and the regulation of social media advertising in Italy.

Genre: Press article / investigative report.

Summary of the text

Paragraph 1: Chiara Ferragni, a top Italian influencer (29.4 million Instagram followers), built an empire through selfies and marketing. She partnered with Balocco to sell a Christmas cake branded with her name at €9 (triple the normal price), claiming proceeds would go to a children's hospital in Turin. In reality, Balocco had only donated €50,000 before the launch and made no further donations.

Paragraph 2: In December, Italian authorities fined both Ferragni and Balocco heavily. Ferragni apologised in a tearful video, calling it a "communication error", and promised to donate €1 million. However, prosecutors launched an aggravated fraud investigation. She lost 200,000

followers and key clients. In response, Italy approved new strict rules forcing influencers with over 1 million followers to label advertising explicitly.

Paragraph 3: The new rules include fines up to €600,000 for unlabelled ads. Some observers predicted Ferragni's end, but the article argues the crisis may be "healthy" as it accelerates regulation and builds market trust. Her recovery depends on learning from her mistakes.

Key vocabulary from the text

Word / Expression	Meaning
to amass a fortune	accumuler une fortune
teetering on the edge	être sur le point de s'effondrer
a cautionary tale	une histoire qui sert d'avertissement
to endorse	promouvoir, approuver publiquement
aggravated fraud	escroquerie aggravée
in the wake of	à la suite de
stringent rules	règles strictes
the fall from grace	la déchéance, la perte de prestige

I. READING COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS (12 MARKS)

Question 1 — Tick the right alternative (1 mark)

The text is mainly about an influencer who...

Correct answer: a. risked a downfall in her career.

Justification: The entire article focuses on Ferragni's scandal, the fraud investigation, the loss of followers and clients, and the threat to her empire ("*teetering on the edge*", "*the fall from grace will spell the end*"). It is not about reaching a peak (b) — the peak is mentioned only as background. Nor is it about a career change (c) — she did not change careers, she faced a crisis within the same career.

Trap: Option (b) might tempt candidates who see "amassed a fortune" in paragraph 1 and think the text is about success. But the main focus is the *scandal and its consequences*.

Question 2 — Complete with information from paragraphs 1 & 2 (4 marks)

Involved parties	Unethical actions	Measures taken
Balocco company	a. Claimed the revenues from the cakes would be donated to a children's hospital, but had given only €50,000 prior to the launch and made no further donations. / Sold the Ferragni-branded cake at €9, almost triple the standard price, while misleading consumers about the charitable purpose.	c. Was hit with heavy fines by the Italian authority. / Was investigated for aggravated fraud.
and Chiara Ferragni	b. Endorsed the Christmas cake and promoted it to her 29.4 million followers without ensuring the donation claims were true. / Participated in a marketing strategy that misled consumers about charitable donations.	d. Apologised in a nearly-tearful video and promised to donate €1 million to the hospital. / Was hit with heavy fines. / Lost 200,000 followers and key clients.

Trap: The question asks for **unethical actions**, not just any action. Writing "she sold a cake" is too neutral. You must mention the *deception* element (false charity claims, inflated price). For measures,

distinguish between what the *authority* did (fines) and what Ferragni did herself (apology, donation promise).

Question 3 — FALSE statements: pick out ONE detail showing each is false (3 marks)

a. "Chiara's activity on social media originally focused on advertising for sweets."

(Paragraph 1)

Detail showing it is FALSE:

"She imparted 'pearls of wisdom' to her followers on how to be effortlessly cool." OR "Chiara Ferragni amassed a fortune through incessant selfie-taking as part of a marketing strategy."

Explanation: Her original activity was about lifestyle, fashion, and "being cool" — not specifically sweets advertising. The cake was a later commercial partnership, not her original focus.

b. "Chiara Ferragni made just a verbal apology to get out of the scandal." (Paragraph 2)

Detail showing it is FALSE:

"In a nearly-tearful video, Ferragni apologised... saying she would donate the €1m she earned from the campaign to the hospital."

Explanation: It was not merely verbal — it was a public video apology +accompanied by a concrete financial commitment (€1 million donation). Moreover, the scandal did not stop there: prosecutors continued investigating her for aggravated fraud.

c. "Chiara's case had only negative impact on consumers." (Paragraph 3)

Detail showing it is FALSE:

"However, this crisis will be healthy. It will accelerate regulations to create more trust in the market." OR "Italy's authority approved new stringent rules, to improve transparency in social media posts."

Explanation: The case had a *positive* impact too: it led to stricter regulations that improve transparency and protect consumers in the future. The word "only" makes the statement false.

Trap: You must quote **ONE detail from the SPECIFIED paragraph**. Quoting from the wrong paragraph = 0. Also, your detail must explicitly contradict the statement. For (c), many candidates miss the word "only" and agree the impact was negative — but the question asks what makes it *false*, i.e., the positive outcome.

Question 4 — Tick the correct option (2 marks)

A. "teetering on the edge" (paragraph 1) nearly means: being on the verge of...

Correct answer: b. collapsing

Explanation: "Teetering" means wobbling unsteadily; "on the edge" implies near collapse. The context confirms this: her empire is in danger after the scandal (fraud investigation, loss of followers). "Fighting" and "restarting" do not fit the negative context.

B. "the fall from grace" (paragraph 3) nearly means: the loss of...

Correct answer: c. status

Explanation: "Fall from grace" is an idiom meaning loss of prestige, reputation, or social standing. Ferragni lost her prestigious position as a top influencer. "Genius" and "funds" are not the core meaning of this expression — though she may have lost money too, the phrase refers primarily to *reputation/status*.

Trap: For B, "funds" (b) might seem tempting because the text mentions money and fines. But "fall from grace" is a **fixed expression** about reputation, not finances. Always check if the phrase is an idiom before choosing a literal answer.

Question 5 — What does the underlined word "they" refer to? (1 mark)

Answer: influencers (or: social media influencers / the influencers).

Context: "After weeks of debate in Italy over the power of influencers and the money made out of products they promote..." (Paragraph 2)

Explanation: The pronoun "they" refers back to the nearest plural noun that makes sense: "influencers". It cannot refer to "prosecutors" (they do not promote products) nor "weeks of debate" (illogical). The antecedent must be a **human agent** capable of promoting products.

Trap: Some candidates might answer "products". But "products" cannot "promote" — they are promoted *by* someone. Always check the **verb** that follows the pronoun to identify the logical subject.

Question 6 — Do you think laws are enough? Justify. (1 mark)

Proposed answer (YES):

I think that laws are enough to improve transparency on social media because strict fines (up to €600,000) will deter influencers from misleading their followers, and explicit labelling will help consumers recognise paid content easily.

Proposed answer (NO):

I do not think that laws are enough to improve transparency on social media because influencers can still find ways to hide advertising through subtle product placement, and laws cannot change people's greed or lack of ethics without education and public awareness.

Trap: This is a 1-mark question — keep it to **one sentence**. Do not write a paragraph. The justification must be **logical** and can refer to the text (fines, labelling) or to general knowledge. Avoid vague answers like "yes because laws are good".

II. WRITING (12 MARKS)

Writing 1 — Forest Therapy paragraph (4 marks)

Develop the following notes into a **4-line paragraph** about Forest Therapy.

Definition: process of relaxation / immerse oneself / nature / use / all five senses

Creation: emerged / Japan / 1980s

Benefits: encourage mindful engagement / physical / mental activities / jogging / meditation
- alternative / screen dependence / stress / our daily lives

Proposed paragraph:

Forest therapy is a process of relaxation in which people immerse themselves in nature and use all five senses to connect with their surroundings. It first emerged in Japan in the 1980s as a response to the growing stress of modern life. This practice encourages mindful engagement through physical and mental activities such as jogging and meditation. As a healthy alternative to screen dependence, forest therapy helps reduce stress and brings balance to our daily lives.

Methodology:

- **Line 1:** Definition (process of relaxation + immerse in nature + five senses).
- **Line 2:** Origin (emerged in Japan / 1980s).
- **Line 3:** Activities/Benefits (mindful engagement + physical/mental activities + examples).
- **Line 4:** Final benefit (alternative to screen dependence + stress reduction + daily lives).

Traps:

1. **Count the lines:** exactly 4 lines. More or less = penalty.
2. **Use ALL the notes:** every keyword must appear. Missing "all five senses" or "1980s" = lost mark.
3. **Grammar and cohesion:** do not just list the notes. Use connectors (which, and, as, through) to build a coherent paragraph.
4. **Do not add invented information:** stick to the notes provided.

Writing 2 — Business blog post: Home Working (8 marks)

*Write a 12-line post for a business blog stating at least **three benefits** and **three challenges** of home working to help hesitant companies make informed decisions.*

Phase 1 — Decoding the task

- **Genre:** Business blog post (professional but accessible tone).
- **Audience:** Company managers/owners who are hesitant about remote work.
- **Purpose:** Inform and persuade — present a balanced view (benefits + challenges).
- **Constraints:** 12 lines, minimum 3 benefits + 3 challenges.

Phase 2 — Proposed plan

Line 1 (Hook): Address the hesitant companies directly.

Lines 2-4 (Benefit 1 + 2): Cost savings + employee satisfaction/retention.

Lines 5-6 (Benefit 3): Access to global talent / flexibility.

Line 7 (Transition): Introduce challenges.

Lines 8-10 (Challenge 1 + 2 + 3): Communication gaps / team cohesion / work-life balance / supervision.

Lines 11-12 (Conclusion): Balanced recommendation — hybrid model as solution.

Phase 3 — Proposed text (12 lines)

1 As more companies embrace remote work, hesitant employers may wonder whether allowing employees to work from home is truly beneficial.

2 The advantages are significant: first, companies can save substantially on office rent and utilities, which directly improves the bottom line.

3 Second, employees often report higher job satisfaction and productivity when they avoid long commutes and manage their own schedules.

4 Third, home working enables businesses to recruit talent from anywhere in the world, breaking geographical barriers.

5 However, this model also presents real challenges that must not be ignored.

6 One major difficulty is maintaining effective communication and collaboration among team members who rarely meet face-to-face.

7 Another challenge is preserving company culture and team cohesion, which can weaken when personal interactions are limited to video calls.

8 Additionally, some managers struggle to monitor performance remotely, while employees may find it hard to separate work from personal life.

9 Cybersecurity risks also increase when staff access sensitive company data from unsecured home networks.

10 Finally, the blurring of boundaries can lead to burnout if employees feel pressured to be constantly available.

11 In conclusion, home working offers clear economic and human benefits, but only if companies address its challenges through clear policies and regular check-ins.

12 A hybrid model, combining remote flexibility with periodic office presence, may be the most balanced path forward for hesitant employers.

Errors that cost the most marks:

1. **Fewer than 3 benefits or 3 challenges:** the rubric explicitly requires at least three of each. Two benefits = automatic penalty.
2. **Wrong register:** a business blog post should be professional but not overly academic. Avoid slang ("cool", "awesome") but also avoid excessive formality ("hereinafter", "aforementioned").
3. **Not addressing hesitant companies:** the post must help them "make informed decisions". A purely descriptive text without advice loses the communicative purpose mark.
4. **Line count:** 12 lines exactly. The examiner counts. Write the line numbers in the margin of your draft to check.
5. **No conclusion / recommendation:** a blog post without a closing recommendation feels incomplete and loses the organisation mark.

III. LANGUAGE (6 MARKS)

Language 1 — Tense and form (3 marks)

Blank	Answer	Explanation
(move) our bodies	moving	"when it comes to" is always followed by V-ing (gerund).
safeguarding (we) future health	our	Possessive adjective required before the noun phrase "future health". "We" is a subject pronoun; "our" is the possessive form.
Recent studies (show)	have shown (or: show)	"Recent" suggests the present perfect (have shown) to link past research to present knowledge. The simple present (show) is also acceptable for general scientific facts.
can be (benefit)	beneficial	After "be" we need an adjective , not a noun or verb. "Benefit" (noun/verb) → "beneficial" (adjective).
spare time (often/cite)	is often cited	Passive voice required: time <i>is cited</i> by people as a barrier. "Often" is an adverb of frequency placed between "is" and "cited".
feeling (fit)	fit (or: fitter)	"Feeling" is a linking verb here; it requires an adjective (fit). "Fitter" (comparative) is also acceptable in parallel with "more time" and "energy", though "fit" is the safer standard answer.

Traps:

- "move" → candidates often write "to move" or "move". Remember: **"when it comes to + V-ing"** is a fixed structure.
- "benefit" → many write "benefited" (past participle) or "benefiting". The sentence needs an **adjective** after "be".
- "often/cite" → the slash indicates two words to insert. Some candidates write only "cited" and forget "often", or write "often cited" without the auxiliary verb "is".

Language 2 — Circle the correct alternative (3 marks)

Gap	Answer	Explanation
our connecting flight (...) due to weather	had been canceled	Past perfect passive . The flight was canceled <i>before</i> they learned about it ("we learned" = simple past). "Had canceled" is active and illogical (the flight did not cancel itself). "Was canceled" is possible but less precise since the cancellation preceded their arrival in Chicago.
we were (...) a flight to Brussels	on	Fixed preposition: " on a flight " (same as "on a plane"). "In" would mean inside the aircraft but not the standard collocation. "At" is for locations (at the airport).
nine hours behind (...)	schedule	Fixed expression: " behind schedule " = en retard sur le planning. "Diary" = agenda personnel. "Agenda" = ordre du jour.
I (...) that my iPhone was gone	realized	"Realized" = se rendre compte. "Recognized" = reconnaître (requires an object you already know). "Emphasized" = souligner (does not fit the context of discovering a loss).
(...), calm settled over me	Strangely	We need an adverb to modify the whole clause. "Stranger" = comparative adjective (noun: inconnu). "Strange" = adjective. "Strangely" = adverb (étrangeté).
I'm not going to let this (...) our vacation	ruin	"Ruin" = gâcher, détruire. "Run" = courir / diriger. "Rate" = évaluer / taux. The context is about not allowing the lost phone to spoil the holiday.

Traps:

- "**had been canceled**" vs "**was canceled**": the past perfect passive is more precise because the cancellation happened *before* the past action "learned". However, in everyday English "was canceled" is sometimes accepted — but in an exam, the past perfect shows better grammatical awareness.
- "**Strangely**" — many candidates circle "Strange" because they think the sentence needs an adjective. But the word modifies the entire clause "calm settled over me", so an **adverb** (-ly) is required.

TIME MANAGEMENT (2-HOUR EXAM)

Phase	Time
Reading the text carefully + underlining key info	10 min
Reading Comprehension (Questions 1-6)	35 min
Writing 1 (Forest Therapy — 4 lines)	10 min
Writing 2 (Blog post — 12 lines): draft + writing	30 min
Language (tenses + alternatives)	20 min
Proofreading (spelling, line count, grammar)	15 min

Specific advice for the Reading section:

- Always **underline** the sentence in the text that justifies your answer before writing it. This prevents invented answers.
- For Question 3 (FALSE statements), the detail you quote must **explicitly contradict** the statement — not just be a different fact.
- For Question 6 (opinion), one clear sentence is enough. Do not overcomplicate a 1-mark question.

Specific advice for the Writing section:

- **Count lines** on your draft. Writing 1 = exactly 4 lines. Writing 2 = exactly 12 lines.
- In Writing 2, use **signposting language**: "First", "Second", "However", "In conclusion" — this improves organisation marks.
- Address the **target audience**: hesitant companies need reassurance but also honest warnings. A one-sided text (only benefits or only challenges) loses marks.

✦ **Correction proposée — bacbymed** ✦

Document non officiel

Destiné à la méthodologie et aux arguments. La rédaction finale reste la responsabilité du candidat.